

Three Meals A Day

Korean Reality TV Show Presentation

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Introduction

- This show start from 2014.10.17 to 2020.7.24.
- Broadcast by tvN (Total Variety TV under CJ ENM. Cable TV) and Produced by Na Young-seok PD.
- 5 Seasons in total. Breakdown to 3 different series and shoot in 4 different Locations. (Jeongseon Village (countryside) – Fishing Village – Gochang Village (countryside, sub) – Ocean Rench)
- Basically The show is about put the celebrities in a rural or fishing village for a few days. Where they could not use any technology or ask help from anyone else except the neighbored. They have to cook three meals a day with local ingredients, experience rural life, and sometimes receive guest celebrities.





Mainly Ideology of the Show and the politics underneath

- Reflection on the fast-paced life of modern society
- Conveying Korean National identities and traditional values.
- Depoliticized Utopianism.



Reflection on the fast-paced life of modern society

- High urbanization and housing, education, and employment pressures
- The increase in the number of people living alone
- Social and psychological health crises such as depression and suicide rates
- This program presents a “slow life” solution to relieve modern anxiety and stress through a narrative of returning to the countryside.

Conveying Korean National Identity and traditional values



- Food
- Food is a cultural narrative
- Respect for Elders. Elders always come first than the younger.
- First Bite Role
- Language Codes
- Food Sovereignty: Elders often control meal decisions, such as ingredient or cooking methods.



Utopianism and Politics behind it



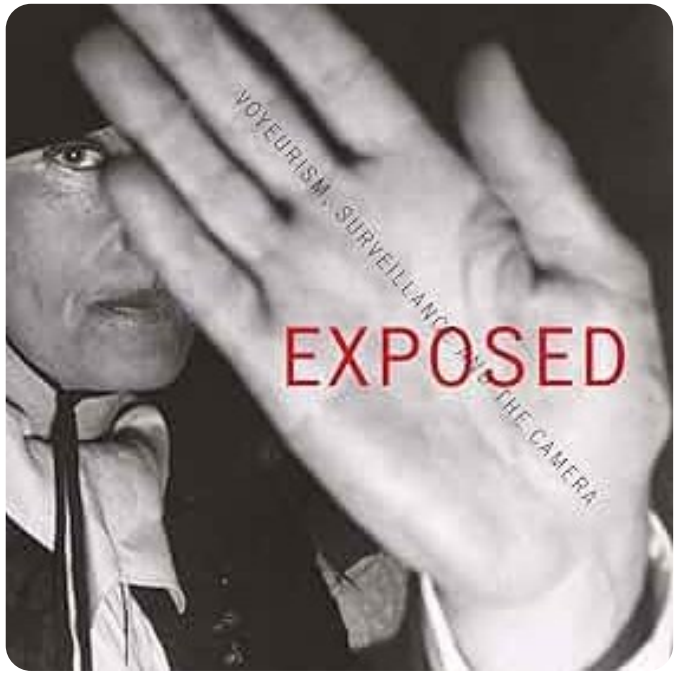
Although the show does not explicitly show any engaged with the political, this seemingly utopian rural life reality show with carefully constructed is deeply political.

- **Visual analyses of representational politics and ideology**

- The camera avoids some "realities" such as rural aging and agricultural bankruptcy and constructs the countryside as a "timeless paradise."

- Celebrities' "experience of poverty" has become a selling point, but economic disparity has never been discussed







- **Political Economy**

- Packaging "rural sentiment" into cultural IP for profit but not solving the decline of rural areas.

- **Surveillance and Voyeurism**

- The audience not only peeks at the private state of celebrities without spotlight but also peeks at the spectacular rural life through the program which transforms social differences into entertainment consumption.

- **Neoliberalism**

-The emphasis on "surviving by cooking for oneself" - blaming systemic poverty on individual ability.

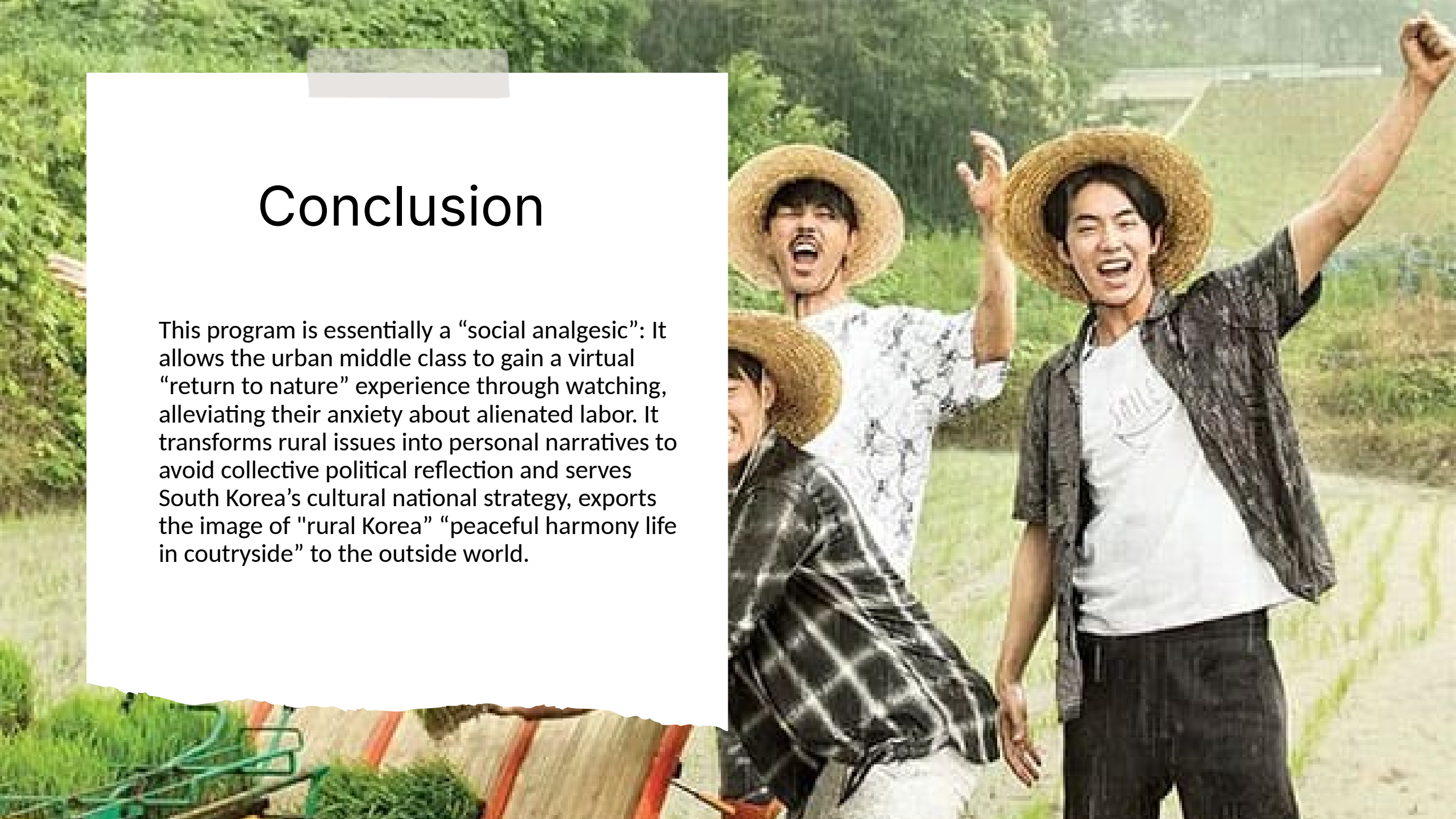
- Did not mention the role of national agricultural subsidies but creates the sense of "self-sufficiency", and indirectly rationalizes the welfare cut policy.

- The setting of celebrities "temporarily doing farming", which avoids the long-term investment required for agriculture. Real farmers cannot leave poverty like celebrities after recording a show



Conclusion

This program is essentially a “social analgesic”: It allows the urban middle class to gain a virtual “return to nature” experience through watching, alleviating their anxiety about alienated labor. It transforms rural issues into personal narratives to avoid collective political reflection and serves South Korea’s cultural national strategy, exports the image of "rural Korea” “peaceful harmony life in coutryside” to the outside world.



Paper Outline

i: Introduction: Introduce the show.

Thesis Statement questions: Why does South Korea need slow reality shows? How do these show through a utopian narrative style, beautify suffering into a consumable healing symbol? What are the ideologies and political positions behind them?

ii: How the Audio-Visual elements and editing help building up the Utopia.

iii: Why Korea need slow reality show or slow lives?

iv: How are national characteristics and traditional values reflected in the show?

v: Politicization and instrumentalization behind this utopian fantasies.

vi: Conclusion

Clip:

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9X2OLaZh_Rc&list=PLr9_Sn69aeIwm9ccKlFLb-KkViZwCtHxW&index=2